

The sand was raked over, and dead gladiators were taken away on stretchers to the mortuary, where their throats were cut. Why? To make sure they really

astonishing 4 times. But he never took the chance to retire. This may seem odd to us, but fighting was all that many gladiators knew.

IN EIGHT GAMES, AUGUSTUS SENT 10,000 FIGHTERS INTO THE ARENA.

were dead and not trying to fake their own deaths! As for the wounded, they were patched up by doctors who made sure they would live to fight again.

And the victorious winners? These gladiators had become the new heroes of the arena. They were presented with their winnings—money and a palm branch. For excellent results, the best fighters were given a laurel wreath to wear on their heads.

The greatest prize of all was the *rudis*—a wooden sword. It was a sign that a gladiator had been given his freedom and could retire to enjoy the money and fame he had earned. One gladiator, named Flamma, seems to have had a remarkable career. He fought 34 times, won 21, drew 9, and was “let go” an

Those who did retire often returned to their gladiator schools to teach the next generation of fighters the brutal skills they needed to stay alive in the arena.

A GLADIATOR RAISES HIS SWORD IN TRIUMPH OVER HIS SLAIN OPPONENT.

